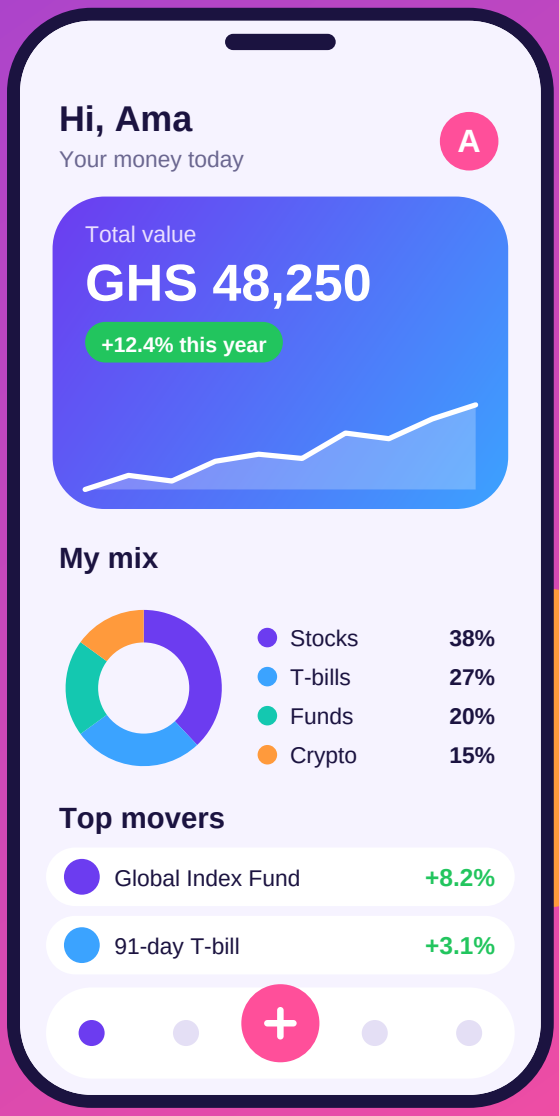
Stackly

Invest together. Track your own.

A colourful, easy-to-use app concept for tracking investments with your friends: UX, UI, investing basics and an honest opinion on whether it is worth building.



01 **Is it worth exploring?**

02 **Name and brand**

03 **UX: users, journey, app map**

04 **UI: colours, type, components**

05 **Screen mock-ups**

06 **Investing basics and methods**

07 **Roadmap and next steps**

Concept document | October 2026 | Sample data used in all mock-ups

Is it worth exploring?

My honest take: the good, the risky and a simple plan

Verdict: YES, explore it - as a personal project first.

For you and your friends it is a low-risk, high-reward idea: genuinely useful, great for learning, and a strong portfolio piece. As a business, the space is crowded, so make that a later decision, not the starting goal.

Why yes

- Excel gets clumsy for charts, phone entry and sharing
- You and your friends are real users from day one
- Great portfolio piece: data, charts, finance and UX in one
- A tracker (no money handling) keeps legal and security load much lighter

Watch-outs

- Live prices cost money or are rate-limited, so start with manual entry
- Bank linking is limited in many African markets
- Friends comparing amounts gets awkward: share percentages only
- Never say "buy" or "sell": stay a tracker, not an adviser

Competition

- Apps like Sharesight, Delta, Snowball Analytics, Getquin and Kubera already exist
- Many focus on US/EU stocks
- Your gap: social but private, plus local assets (T-bills, unit trusts, land, group savings) and multi-currency

My scorecard

(my own judgement out of 10, not hard data)



Suggested path

1

Week 1

Tidy your Excel: list assets, columns and categories you really use.

2

Weeks 2-6

Build the MVP: manual entry, dashboard, charts, Friends Circle.

3

Weeks 7-8

Test with 5-10 friends. Watch what they actually use.

4

Then decide

Keep it personal, polish it, or grow it into a product.

Name and brand

Catchy, friendly and easy to say in any country

Stackly

Invest together. Track your own.

Short, easy to spell and say. "Stack" works three ways: stacking coins, stacking assets into a portfolio, and a stack of friends growing together. The "-ly" ending feels friendly and modern.

Tagline options

- **Invest together. Track your own.**
- **Grow your money. Grow your circle.**
- **Your portfolio, beautifully simple.**

App icon on any background



Runner-up names

Gainly
Clear and positive, but focuses only on profit.

Sproutly
Growth theme, friendly. "Sprout" names are common in finance.

Circlefolio
Circle + portfolio. Describes it well, a bit long.

Susu Square
Ghana-flavoured, community feel. Strong locally, less global.

Brand voice

- Friendly and encouraging, like a clever friend
- Plain English: "you gained", not "alpha generated"
- Celebrates progress, never shames losses
- Never preachy and never gives buy/sell orders

Before you commit to the name

- I have not checked trademarks, domains or app-store names for Stackly
- Search the name in the stores and your target countries first
- Grab matching social handles and a domain early
- Have a backup name ready from the list

UX: easy by design

Who it is for, how it flows and how the app is organised

Who it is for (example personas)

A — Ama
The Beginner

A few T-bills and a unit trust. Wants one clear number and zero jargon.

Needs: simple home, tooltips, Learn tab

K — Kofi
The Enthusiast

Stocks and crypto, loves charts. Wants detail, comparison and bragging rights.

Needs: asset detail, XIRR, Circle ranking

E — Efua
The Saver

Invests monthly and saves for land. Wants goals and reminders.

Needs: recurring top-ups, goals, nudges

Five design principles

1. **3 taps to add** — Any investment in under 20 seconds
2. **Plain English** — No jargon without a tooltip
3. **Private by default** — Friends see % only, never amounts
4. **Forgiving** — Edit and undo everything
5. **Delightful** — Confetti when goals are hit

The core journey

Open app ▸ See total ▸ Tap + ▸ Pick type ▸ Enter amount ▸ Saved!

Whole journey from opening the app to a saved investment: about 20 seconds

App map (bottom tab bar)

Home	Portfolio	+ Add	Circle	Learn
Total value	All holdings	Pick a type	Invite friends	Investing basics
Trend chart	Filter by type	Amount and date	% leaderboard	Glossary
Asset mix	Asset detail	Notes and tags	Challenges	Strategy cards
Top movers	Transactions	Recurring buy	Privacy controls	Mini quizzes
Goals preview	Dividends	Import CSV	Cheers	Tips

Navigation: a thumb-friendly bottom tab bar with a glowing + button in the middle.

Everything important is one tap from Home. No hidden menus, no maze of settings.

UI: colourful and clear

Colour palette, typography and building blocks

Colour palette

Brand	Action	Energy	Reward	Calm	Trust	Up	Down	Text
Purple #6C3CF0	Pink #FF4F9A	Orange #FF9A3C	Sunshine #FFD23F	Teal #14C8B0	Sky #3BA3FF	Gain #22C55E	Loss #FF5A5F	Ink #1B1340

Green and red are used only for gains and losses (always with an up/down arrow and a + or - sign, so colour-blind users are covered). Every asset type gets its own colour so the mix is readable at a glance.

Asset colours

Stocks · T-bills · Funds · ETFs · Real estate · Cash · Crypto · Other

Typography

Aa

Poppins Bold

Headings and big numbers. Round, friendly shapes.

Inter Regular

Body text and tables. Very readable.

GHS 48,250

Body text stays at 14-16 pt on phones.

CAPTIONS AND LABELS USE 11-12 PT

(Free Google Fonts. This PDF uses Helvetica as a stand-in.)

Components

Add investment | Compare | Skip for now | + Main + button

▲ +12.4% | ▼ -3.1% | Stocks | Funds | Crypto — Gain/loss pills and filter chips

Goal: Emergency fund 70%

Show my amounts to friends

OFF by default

Global Index Fund +8.2%

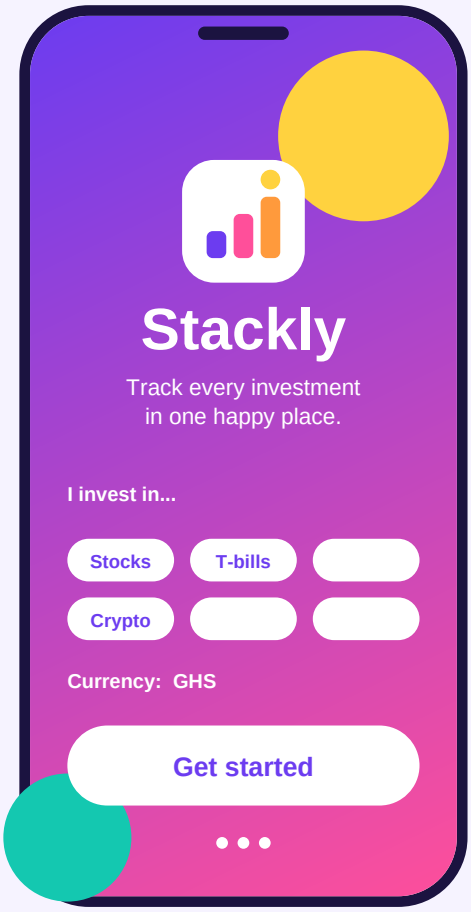
List row: one line, one colour, one number

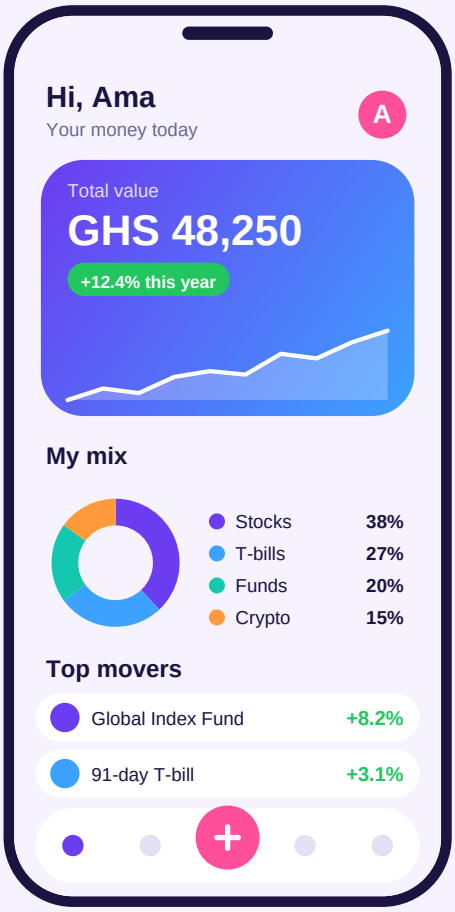
Design details that make it feel good

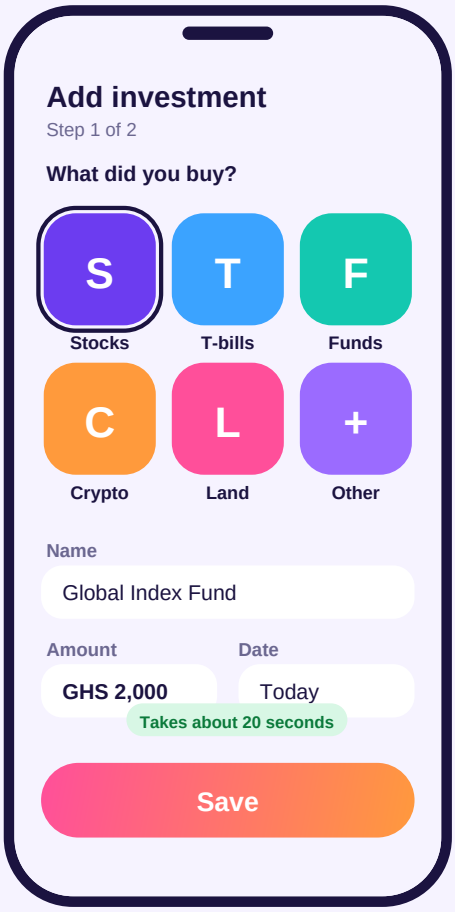
- Rounded corners (16-24 px) and soft shadows
- Generous spacing on an 8-pt grid
- Big 48 px tap targets for thumbs
- Light and dark mode from day one
- Small celebrations: confetti and badges
- Empty states that explain, not scold

Screens: first steps

Welcome, Home and Add investment (sample data)







1. Welcome

Two quick choices (what you invest in, currency) and you are in. No bank login, no long forms.

2. Home

One big number first. Mix donut and top movers follow. The pink + is always in reach.

3. Add investment

Big colourful tiles instead of dropdowns. Smart defaults: today's date, last-used currency.

Design notes

Welcome

- Skippable and short
- Choices shape the home screen
- Friendly, not formal

Home

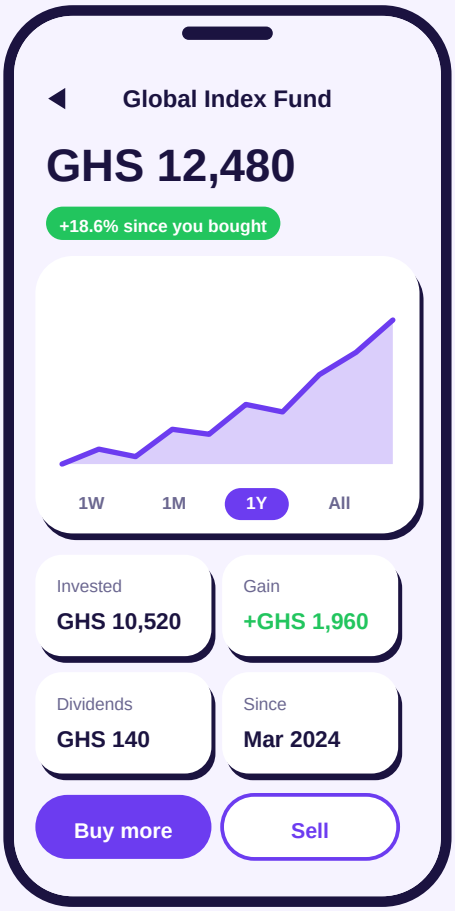
- Answers "how am I doing?" in 1 second
- Colours match asset types everywhere
- Everything else is one scroll away

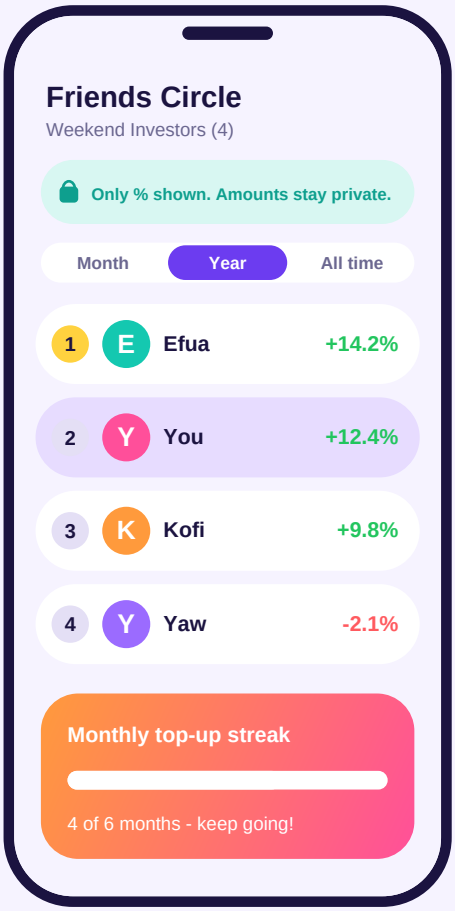
Add

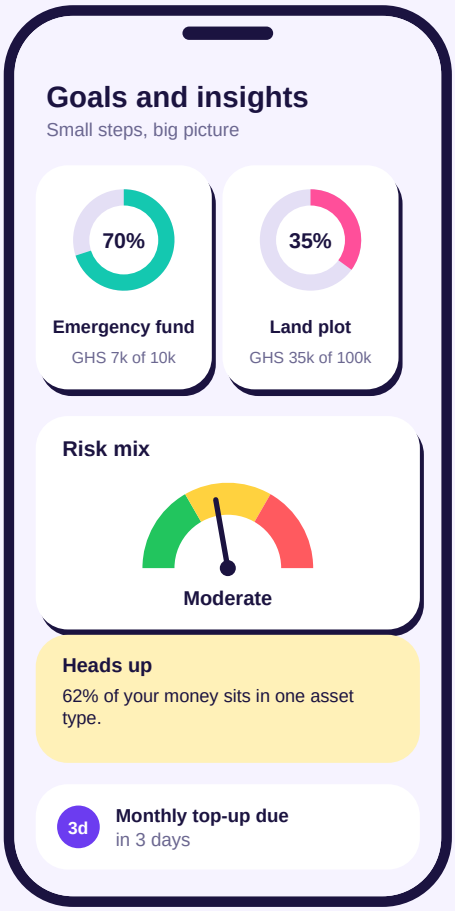
- Under 20 seconds, 3 taps
- Recurring buys can be set once
- CSV import for your Excel history

Screens: going deeper

Asset detail, Friends Circle and Goals (sample data)







4. Asset detail

Value, trend and plain-English stats. Range chips switch between a week and all time.

5. Friends Circle

Shares only percentages, never amounts. Rankings, streaks and friendly challenges.

6. Goals and insights

Progress rings, a simple risk meter and gentle heads-ups that describe, never advise.

Design notes

Detail

- Plain words: "Invested", "Gain"
- Buy more / Sell always visible
- Dividends tracked separately

Circle

- Opt in per holding
- Hide the leaderboard anytime
- Cheers, not pressure

Goals

- Insights describe your portfolio
- They never say what to buy or sell
- Reminders keep habits going

Investing basics: the asset types

The main places people put their money

Stocks (shares)

You own a small slice of a company. Value moves with company results and market mood. Some pay dividends.

Good for
Long-term growth you can leave alone for years.

Risk	Return potential	Easy to sell
●●●●○	●●●●○	●●●●○

Bonds and T-bills

You lend money to a government or company and get interest. T-bills are short-term government loans.

Good for
Steady income and money you want to keep safer.

Risk	Return potential	Easy to sell
●●○○○	●●○○○	●●●○○

Mutual and unit trusts

A professional manager pools many investors' money into a mix of assets. Fees apply.

Good for
Hands-off diversification from small amounts.

Risk	Return potential	Easy to sell
●●●○○	●●●○○	●●●○○

ETFs and index funds

Funds that copy a market index. ETFs trade like shares. Low fees and instant diversification.

Good for
Simple, low-cost, long-term investing.

Risk	Return potential	Easy to sell
●●●○○	●●●○○	●●●●○

Real estate and land

Property, land or property funds. Can rise in value and earn rent, but is hard to sell fast and needs big sums.

Good for
Long-term wealth and inflation protection.

Risk	Return potential	Easy to sell
●●●○○	●●●○○	●○○○○

Cash and money market

Savings accounts, money-market funds and cash. Very stable, but returns can lag behind inflation.

Good for
Emergency fund and short-term goals.

Risk	Return potential	Easy to sell
●○○○○	●○○○○	●●●●●

Crypto assets

Digital assets such as Bitcoin. Prices swing wildly and the rules are still evolving.

Good for
A small, high-risk slice, only if you understand it.

Risk	Return potential	Easy to sell
●●●●●	●●●●●	●●●●○

Commodities and others

Gold, farmland, private businesses or group savings such as susu. Each has its own rules and risks.

Good for
Going beyond markets. Know the terms first.

Risk	Return potential	Easy to sell
●●●●○	●●●○○	●●○○○

Ratings are simple, general illustrations, not predictions. Real results vary a lot. Check what is available and regulated where you live.

Investing methods and strategies

Nine common approaches in plain English

1 Dollar-cost averaging

Invest a fixed amount on a schedule (say monthly), whatever the price.

Good
Builds a habit. No need to time the market.

Watch out
Does not guarantee profit. Fees on tiny buys add up.

2 Lump-sum investing

Invest a large amount in one go.

Good
Your money starts working immediately.

Watch out
Bad timing hurts and can feel stressful.

3 Buy and hold

Buy quality assets and keep them for years, ignoring daily noise.

Good
Low costs and low stress.

Watch out
Needs patience through big drops.

4 Index investing

Buy a fund that tracks a whole market instead of picking winners.

Good
Instant diversification, low fees.

Watch out
You get the market return, good or bad.

5 Value investing

Look for assets priced below what they seem to be worth.

Good
A cushion if your research is right.

Watch out
Needs research. Cheap can stay cheap.

6 Growth investing

Back businesses that are growing fast.

Good
High upside potential.

Watch out
Often pricey. Can fall hard if growth slows.

7 Dividend and income

Hold assets that pay you regularly: dividends, interest or rent.

Good
Steady cash flow.

Watch out
Very high yields can signal trouble. Payouts can be cut.

8 Diversification

Spread money across asset types, sectors and countries to match your goals and comfort with risk.

Good
A smoother ride.

Watch out
Too many holdings are hard to follow.

9 Rebalancing

Once or twice a year, return to your target mix: trim winners, top up laggards.

Good
Keeps risk in check.

Watch out
May involve trading costs and taxes.

How Stackly helps:
tag each holding with its strategy, set recurring-buy reminders, and compare your mix with your own target.

Numbers that matter

A mini glossary, risk basics and golden rules

Key metrics the app will calculate

Gain / loss	Money made or lost so far.	`current value - amount invested`
ROI	Return as a percentage of what you put in.	`(value - cost) / cost x 100`
CAGR	Smoothed yearly growth rate over several years.	`(end / start)^(1/years) - 1`
XIRR	Yearly return that respects the timing of each deposit. Best for regular top-ups.	`Excel: =XIRR(values, dates)`
Dividend yield	Yearly income as a percentage of the price.	`annual dividends / price`
Expense ratio	Yearly fund fee, taken from your money in the fund.	`fee % per year`
Volatility	How wildly the price swings. Higher means a bumpier ride.	`spread of returns`
Drawdown	Fall from a past peak to a low point.	`(low - peak) / peak`
Real return	Return after inflation. Vital where prices rise quickly.	`approx: return % - inflation %`

Risk vs return (the general idea)



Higher potential return usually comes with higher risk. Nothing is guaranteed, and past performance does not predict the future.

Beginner golden rules

- Build an emergency fund first
- Invest only money you can leave alone for years
- Diversify: do not put everything in one basket
- Watch fees and inflation, they quietly eat returns
- Do not invest in what you cannot explain
- Be wary of "guaranteed high returns": a classic scam sign
- Review on a schedule, not every hour

Roadmap and next steps

From Excel to MVP to a full product

Feature roadmap

MVP (v1)

- Add and edit holdings and transactions by hand
- Multi-currency (GHS, USD...) with manual rates
- Home: total, trend and asset mix
- Import from your Excel (CSV)
- Friends Circle: invite link, % only
- Light and dark mode

Version 2

- Live prices for shares, ETFs and crypto
- Goals and recurring reminders
- Dividend and interest tracker
- Portfolio insights (concentration)
- Export a PDF report
- Home-screen widgets

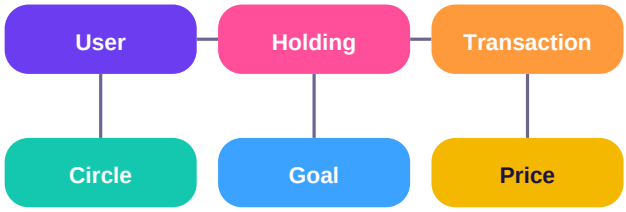
Version 3

- Group challenges and badges
- Shared watchlists
- Local data: T-bill rates, local exchange
- Advanced analytics (XIRR, benchmarks)
- Investment-club mode
- Optional premium plan

Suggested tech stack

- App: Flutter or React Native (iOS + Android from one codebase), or a web app (PWA) for the fastest start
- Backend: Firebase or Supabase (login, database, free tier)
- Charts: fl_chart, Victory or Recharts
- Prices later via a market-data API (check cost and licence)
- Security: email/Google login, biometric lock, never store bank passwords

Simple data model



Holdings have many transactions. Circles share only percentages, never amounts.

Your next steps

- [ ] Write down what you track in Excel today (columns, asset types)
- [ ] Sketch Home, Add and Circle on paper
- [ ] Test with 5-10 friends for a month and collect feedback
- [ ] Ask 3 friends what would make them open it weekly
- [ ] Pick a stack and build the MVP in small weekly steps
- [ ] Check the name, domain and local rules before going public

Educational concept document, not financial, legal or tax advice. All figures and names in the mock-ups are sample data. If you ever handle other people's money or recommend investments, check the rules of your local securities regulator first.